

MetaHOPE - News Metaphor Translation Annotation Guideline

Annotator Version

1. Annotation Task

Objective

This annotation task evaluates the translation quality of metaphorical expressions in news translation.

Note: Only the highlighted metaphorical expressions are evaluated.

- Source metaphorical expressions are shown in bold and underlined in the source text.

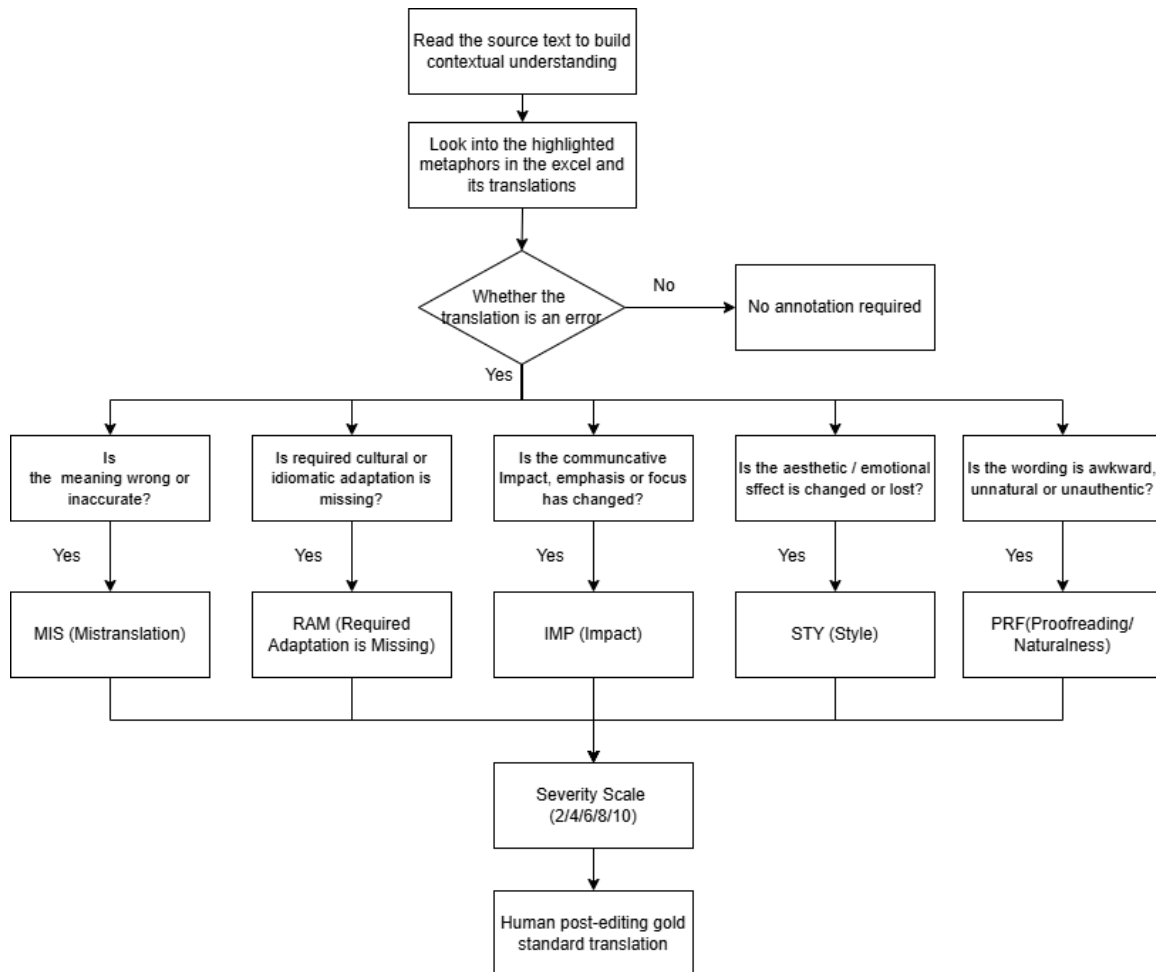
钱老师连连摆手：“论苦心大是周彤，为迎接竞赛做题三千多道，草稿纸堆起来只怕比他人还高。”

- Their corresponding translations are already marked in bold and underlined in the target text.

Teacher Qian waved his hands repeatedly, "Zhou Tong has put in the most effort. To prepare for the competition, he did over three thousand problems; the pile of draft paper is probably taller than everyone else's."

- Annotators should evaluate only these highlighted metaphorical expressions. And the rest of the sentence is provided only for context and should not be evaluated.

2. Annotation Procedure



Step 1: Read the Full Context (texts are in the folder and are named with docid)

Read the entire article to understand the overall topic, discourse context, communicative purpose, and intended meaning of the metaphor.

Step 2: Determine Whether an Error Exists

Question: Does the translation contain a metaphor-related translation error?

Options:

- No Error
- Error

If no error is identified, no further annotation is required.

Step 3: Identify Error Type(s) (See below)

If an error exists, select one or more error categories from the framework below.

Multiple error types may be assigned to the same instance.

Step 4: Assign Severity

Step 5: Post-edit Suggestion (Optional) (See below)

If an error is identified, the annotator can provide a suggested revision in the Human Gold Standard column.

3. Decision Rules

Priority Rules

- If the intended meaning is incorrect or cannot be recovered → MIS.
- If the meaning is correct but a suitable metaphorical adaptation is missing → RAM.
- If the meaning is correct but communicative impact changes → IMP.
- If the meaning is correct but metaphorical or emotional effect is weakened → STL.
- If the meaning is correct and only naturalness is affected → PRF.

4. Error Categories

IMP (Impact)

Meaning is generally preserved, but communicative impact, emphasis, agency, or information structure changes.

EN: The government cracked down on protesters after the unrest.

ZH: 抗议者在骚乱后被镇压 (gloss: *Protesters were cracked down after the unrest.*)

->suggest translation:政府在骚乱后镇压抗议者 (gloss: : The government cracked down on protesters after the unrest.)

RAM (Required Adaptation Missing)

A culturally or idiomatically appropriate metaphorical equivalent exists in the target language but is not used.

EN: The company is a black sheep in the field.

ZH: 这个公司是行业里的问题公司 (*problematic company*)

->suggest translation:害群之马(gloss: *a horse that harms the group*)

MIS (Mistranslation)

The metaphor is misunderstood, incorrectly interpreted, or fails to convey the intended meaning.

EN: The company is on its last legs after years of losses.

ZH: 该公司在多年亏损后正处于它的最后几条腿上 (gloss: *on its last legs*)。

-> suggest translation: 倒闭边缘 (gloss: *on the edge of bankruptcy*)

STL (Style)

The meaning is largely preserved, but metaphorical imagery, rhetorical force, or emotional intensity is weakened.

Example:

EN: Officials lashed out at the decision, calling it irresponsible.

ZH: 官员对这一决定表示不满 (gloss: *express dissatisfaction*), 称其不负责任。

-> suggest translation: 强烈抨击 (gloss: *strongly attack*)

PRF (Proofreading / Naturalness)

The meaning is preserved, but the wording is awkward, unnatural, or non-idiomatic.

Example:

EN: The plan has gained momentum in recent weeks.

ZH: 该计划在最近几周获得了动量 (momentum)。

-> suggest translation: 势头 (gloss: *momentum*)

5. Severity Scale

2 – Minor

Slight issue with little effect on understanding.

4 – Moderate

Noticeable issue with some loss of stylistic or metaphorical effect.

6 – Major

An important aspect of metaphor meaning or effect is lost.

8 – Severe

Core metaphorical meaning is substantially distorted.

10 – Critical

The intended metaphorical meaning is largely lost or seriously misunderstood.

6. Pilot Annotation

Annotators first complete a pilot annotation of 20 instances.

Disagreements are discussed and the guideline is refined if necessary before formal annotation begins.

Inter-annotator agreement is calculated after the pilot stage and again after the main annotation stage.

7. Annotator Requirements

Annotators should have a background in translation.

Preferred qualifications include:

- CATTI Level 2 or above
- MTI or Translation Studies training
- Professional translation experience
- Equivalent academic expertise in translation

Knowledge of metaphor translation is desirable but not required.